

AI in Marketing, Tool or Threat?

Spencer Van Goor

Rutgers University

Writing in the Professions 355

Professor Joann Messina

April 12, 2026

Introduction and Professional Background

The continued constant addition of generative artificial intelligence into marketing strategies and practices has quickly transformed an industry that was once dominated by creative development and is now defined by technological fluency and data oversight. As these algorithmic tools change how campaigns are set up and put together, marketing professionals face constantly evolving job responsibilities that now reach past creative strategies and into verification, oversight, and analytics. These structural shifts, now widely discussed in academic and industry-wide research, are much clearer when examined through real professional experience. Jo Trizila, founder and CEO of TrizCom, a self-established marketing and communications firm, offers her insights into how technological acceleration influences daily marketing objectives, data analysis, and expectations of creative authority. After founding TrizCom in 2008, Trizila has overseen brand strategy, media relations, and consumer data analytics prior to and following the widespread adoption of AI-led marketing strategies, allowing her to directly observe the changes in expectations for the skill sets of marketers following the technological expansion that generative AI has presented. Her experience further conveys how marketing professionals are no longer solely creative strategists but also data interpreters, digital system managers, and output overseers, reflecting the broader industry trends identified in academic research on generative AI in marketing fields. Trizila's professional experience properly demonstrates that AI is not replacing creative labor in marketing but rather redefining it by shifting the roles of marketers towards ethical data oversight and analytical interpretation and finding a balance between human-led decision-making and AI integration.

Interview and Analysis

Trizila's description of her day-to-day responsibilities revealed how current marketing has drastically shifted toward frequent technological monitoring and adaptation rather than primarily focusing on creative production. She stressed that "never one day is the same, and everything always changes rapidly," and emphasized how much of her time is spent "always looking at analytics and AI reports of change" monitoring journalism trends, conducting ongoing research on content, and identifying client audiences before producing content (J. Trizila, personal communication, March 26, 2026). This exhibited workflow highlights how marketing professionals now work within environments now defined by constant data oversight and interpretation rather than creative campaign development. The necessity of studying algorithmic performance and reacting quickly to digital trends further proves how these generative technological systems are shaping decision-making timelines. While marketing began as an industry prioritizing long-form creative planning, Trizila's experience showed the new balance that professionals must now balance. Her emphasis on monitoring and researching heightened a broader industry transformation in which marketers are now required to interpret and use technological outputs as market researchers would, suggesting that professional success increasingly depends on "having the creativity, flexibility, and drive to find the balance" (J. Trizila, personal communication, March 26, 2026). After considering her take on AI and its place in the marketing field, it ultimately changed my perspective from AI strictly being a threat to marketing and marketing professionals to understanding how to use it effectively as a tool, especially for data analytics and oversight automation. Rather than resisting this inevitable marketing change, Trizila demonstrated how important it is to strategically integrate AI while maintaining creative control within a brand.

Even though artificial intelligence plays a growing role in marketing skillsets, Trizila repeatedly differentiated AI's benefits and creative limitations. She noted that in her own workplace, "AI is primarily used for data-driven decision-making, but rarely used for creative development," depicting it as a "fun ideation tool" that cannot replace human-led creative efforts, let alone guide brand direction (J. Trizila, personal communication, March 26, 2026). Her stance highlighted the important boundary separating efficiency and originality within creative-dominant practices. She then states that authentic brand communication truly depends on human interpretation because "AI doesn't have full understanding of brands when not inputted, and it waters down brand voice," clearly reflecting the practical challenges that marketing professionals face when adapting and integrating automated tools into creative-dominated industries (J. Trizila, personal communication, March 26, 2026). While AI can be beneficial for preliminary brainstorming and research, it lacks the contextual awareness that a human would have which puts brand identity and tone at risk and therefore requires marketers to then reinterpret and refine generated ideas to verify alignment with brand values. Trizila's experience then suggests that creativity is still a human responsibility, reinforcing the idea that artificial intelligence has not yet eliminated creative work from humans, but instead made creative oversight more essential for marketers.

Trizila additionally described how AI has reshaped the expectations for marketing professionals with the introduction of new technical advancements and oversight-style responsibilities, challenging the common assumption that AI promotes and provides strictly efficiency when it comes to automated tasks. She explained that "you must know how to properly navigate AI. It is necessary to succeed," adding that the understanding of both AI and the detection of AI has quickly become a required professional skill when applying for a job now

(J. Trizila, personal communication, March 26, 2026). Rather than either simplifying workloads or blatantly increasing marketer workload, she demonstrated how automation often does both and redistributes labor into different verification tasks. Trizila characterized AI as a “no-win situation,” noting that even though it can reduce the time taken to compose and analyze a marketing strategy, it still requires a hefty amount of oversight to ensure lack of bias and correct brand communication (J. Trizila, personal communication, March 26, 2026). Her insight shows that AI introduces efficiency as well as heightened responsibility, which requires marketers to then serve as creatives, analysts, and editors of artificially generated outputs; the profession therefore evolves by expanding the scope of professional accountability, rather than removing human involvement.

Despite the acknowledged challenges, Trizila framed AI as a tool whose effectiveness depends on control and ethical application. She emphasized that human judgement is “the most important thing” in marketing decisions, identifying the main principles of EEAT (expertise, experience, authority, and trustworthiness), a marketing strategy she learned in her Masters in Business at the University of Dallas (J. Trizila, personal communication, March 26, 2026). Looking to the future, Trizila expressed cautious optimism, acknowledging that marketing professionals are “being given more opportunities” as AI continues to grow algorithmically, while advising that prospective marketing professionals “learn how to use it ethically, and never stop learning” (J. Trizila, personal communication, March 26, 2026). Her perspective positions AI as less of a threat to creative-led industries, and as more of a disguised catalyst for redefining professional responsibility. These reflections suggest that sustainable success in marketing depends on human creativity being maintained, keeping ethics in reasoning, and having critical thinking and judgement skills alongside technological adaptation, illustrating how industry

transformation reinforces the continued necessity of human leadership with the continued rise of technology.

Conclusion

The interview that was conducted with Jo Trizila has proven how AI may not entirely be a threat to creative-led industries like marketing but could be a tool if used ethically and analytically. Jo Trizila's experiences in the marketing and communications industry have illustrated the transition of marketing from a limited, collective media environment to one defined by more thorough personalization and constant access. Through analysis of her anecdotes and experiences, my interview with her reinforces my central argument of research: marketing is most effective and ethical when humans stay in creative positions. While I initially viewed AI as a general threat to the marketing industry, particularly towards creative labor, Trizila's insights changed my perspective to understand AI as a something to learn and not to fear as a threat. Ultimately, Trizila's media history highlights the importance of technological accessibility, cultural norms, and human labor in creative fields work together to shape the marketing industry into what it is today.

Research Questions

1. Can you describe your current role and primary responsibilities that you handle on a daily/weekly basis?
2. What types of writing and research are used by you and your company?
3. What skills and experiences helped you enter this field?
4. How has marketing changed during the time that you have worked in the industry considering the growth of digital generative tools?
5. What role does AI currently play in your company?
6. How have AI tools influenced creative v. data-driven balance? And have you noticed changes in brand voice and company image homogenization from when AI tools are involved?
7. How have AI tools changed skill sets of marketers today compared to when you entered the field?
8. Do AI tools reduce workload, create new tasks, or aid in analysis/organization? How so?

9. What parts of marketing do you think AI handles well? And what challenges does AI additionally bring into marketing processes?
10. How important is human judgement in marketing decisions when AI tools are involved?
Can you name any situations where human review was necessary to correct AI-generated outcomes?
11. How do you see the role of marketing professionals changing as AI continues to develop?
12. What advice would you have for young marketing professionals entering the marketing industry today?